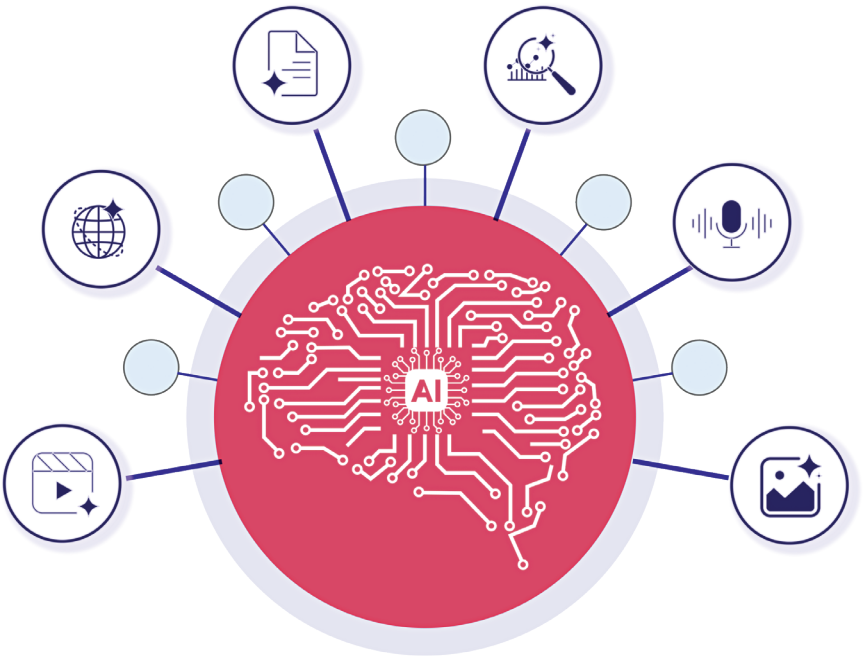


Multimodal AI

Choose the Right AI Model

Match the model to your task, hardware, and language

There is a dangerous habit in local AI: looking for "the best model" before deciding what you want the model to do. It is the equivalent of walking into a computer shop and asking for the best PC without saying whether you plan to write essays, edit 4K video or play games.

Open models make that mistake especially easy because the shelves are effectively infinite. The same family may contain tiny models intended for modest devices, larger reasoning models, vision-capable versions, coding specialists and multiple quantisations of each. Then there are models from Google, Qwen, Mistral, Meta, OpenAI, Sarvam and dozens of smaller research groups.

Your job is not to find the most impressive benchmark number. It is to find the model that gives you the best combination of capability, speed and memory use for your tasks and your computer.

Step 1: Start with the job, not the model

Before opening Hugging Face, write down the three things you expect your local AI to do most often.

For example:

1. Summarise long PDFs and rewrite text.
2. Help with Python and explain code.
3. Answer questions in English and Hindi.